GinCol Lab · Aula

Student worksheet

Philosophy · 1st year of Bachillerato · What is philosophy and what is it for? · Class 5 of 7 · With Javier

Where philosophical problems hide

Class video: https://youtu.be/63OHzS2NOLg

The code leads to the video.

Name: _____ Date: _____

Before you start

1. Write a question you think science will never be able to answer. Why do you think so?

2. For you, what is the difference between philosophy and science? And between philosophy and religion? One sentence for each.

3. **At the end of the class.** Reread your two answers. Does your question still stand? Would you change your sentences? Why?

While you watch the video

1. **Your memory.** Before Javier says it: for Thomas Aquinas, how does philosophy differ from theology?

2. Why were the astronomers voting in Prague? What problem did Eris bring?

3. **Your prediction.** To find out whether Pluto is a planet, what instrument would settle it?

4. How many planets did the proposal of 16 August 2006 give? How many did the one approved on the 24th give? What changed in those eight days, and what didn't?

5. What are the three conditions for being a planet? Which one does Pluto not meet? What does «having cleared» the neighbourhood around its orbit mean?

6. The New Horizons probe closed one question and left another open. Which are they? Why does one end and the other not?

7. What does Plato ask for in the *Phaedrus*? How does the class take it to the planets?

8. There are two ways of cutting. What does each one look at, and how many planets does it give? Why won't one more piece of data make them agree?

9. Why does the class say that, with Pluto, it's «in part» only a word? What question remains underneath, one that can't be voted on? What does it have to do with death?

10. **Stop and think.** Fill in the table of the test (below).

11. Why does the question about driving still stand and yet isn't a philosophical problem? What does the class add to the test?

12. **Stop and think.** «If you can't measure it, it's pure opinion.» Apply its own rule to it. What happens?

13. Fill in the table of the four ways of looking (below). Why does the class say that «almost everyone reasons»?

14. What is Russell's no man's land? How can you see that this border moves?

15. Russell and Thomas Aquinas draw a line in the same place. What is left on each side? How are they opposed?

16. What did Gould propose? What did Dawkins reply? Why does the class say it is, once again, a philosophical problem?

17. The hunt in the news story: which data questions are set aside? What still stands with all the data? What is left when the names are removed?

18. What does Mill say about using power against someone? Whom does he leave out? How does that change the question?

19. Write one argument from those who defend these laws and one from those who criticise them. No verdict: your position goes in «For you».

20. Why is only the third step left in the film? What question appears when the names are removed?

21. Why did Aristotle say that poetry is more philosophical than history? What is the opposite path we take?

The all-the-data test

Question	With all the data, does it end or does it still stand?	Are there reasons that carry weight?	What is it?
How many stars does the Milky Way have?			
Is it right to lie so as not to do harm?			
How does the brain change between the ages of 16 and 20?			
At what age should someone be an adult in the eyes of the law?			
Should we drive on the right, or on the left?			

The four ways of looking at the same sky:

	What it asks	What it rests on
Science (Cecilia Payne)		
Religion (the psalm)		

	What it asks	What it rests on
Art (Van Gogh)		
Philosophy (Kant)		

In class: the hunt

Your group gets a card with a headline or a work.

1. **Your prediction**, without talking to anyone: what question do you think is hiding here?

2. **Step one.** Write the data questions. Set them aside: they need answering properly, but not here.

3. **Step two.** Imagine you already have all the data. Does it end there? Write what still stands, with all its names.

4. **Step three.** Cross out the names and the dates. Write the question that's left: it has to work for other cases.

5. **Blind.** Swap the question with another group, without showing the card. That group judges it: are there reasons that carry weight, or does it make no difference and is it enough to agree? Which branch does it belong to? Only one?

6. Your question, as it has ended up: .....

7. Compare it with your prediction. Which is deeper? Why?

For you

1. What question do you ask yourself that would still stand with all the data?

2. How far can someone's freedom be limited in order to protect them: write your position, with a reason, an objection and your reply.

3. If you were Truman, what would you do at the door? Why?

4. In what do you let others think for you because it's more comfortable? Is it worth it to you?

Practice

1. In which does the question still stand? How much will the sea rise this century? What do we owe to those not yet born?

2. Choose a headline from today, apply the three steps and say which branch the remaining question belongs to.

3. Choose a film, a series or a song, and write its question, without names.

Keep thinking

When a question still stands with all the data, is it very deep? Or is it badly put?

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